The Shade That Wandered

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 11

Nib put the umbrella beside a resting board. Its shade fell beautifully over the grass. Unfortunately, the bag was on the board. When Nib moved the bag into the shade, he sat down in the sunny place it had left. Lark watched the patch of light with a thoughtful smile.

“The shade wandered,” Nib complained mildly. “The umbrella stayed where we put it,” Lark observed with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cup**

“Lowercase w begins wet,” Lark modeled clearly. “Round your lips, then move smoothly into the next sound: /w/. Join w, e, t. Compare wet with the sun label on our resting-place note. The words tell us something about each place.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try web, wet, win, wag. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read wet and sun,” Lark invited gently. “Which place is dry, and what does it still need for a comfortable rest?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam got wet. Pat did not get wet.**

“Which friend stayed dry?” Lark asked gently. “Find the word that changes what happened.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib set the bag on the dry board. Lark moved the umbrella's support so its shade covered that board, then anchored its base. Nobody disturbed the spider web beside the shelter. Now the dry resting place was shaded as well. The crew sat together, with Fern Lodge's invitation protected beside them.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write w beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

After the rest, Fern Lodge's porch was close enough to see. Lark packed the umbrella and checked the route note. A folded receiving sack hung beside the doorway, ready for the last invitation.